

NBA Player Value Model

Evaluating Player Performance Relative to Salary

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Stats Overview

Win Shares

Converts a player's overall performance into an estimate of how many wins they helped produce.

Assist %

Estimates the percentage of teammates' made field goals a player assists on while they are on the court.

DBPM

Defensive Box Plus-Minus (DBPM) estimates a player's defensive impact per 100 possessions using box score stats and team performance.

Steal %

Estimates how often a player causes a steal while on the court, reflecting their ability to disrupt offenses and create turnovers.

VORP

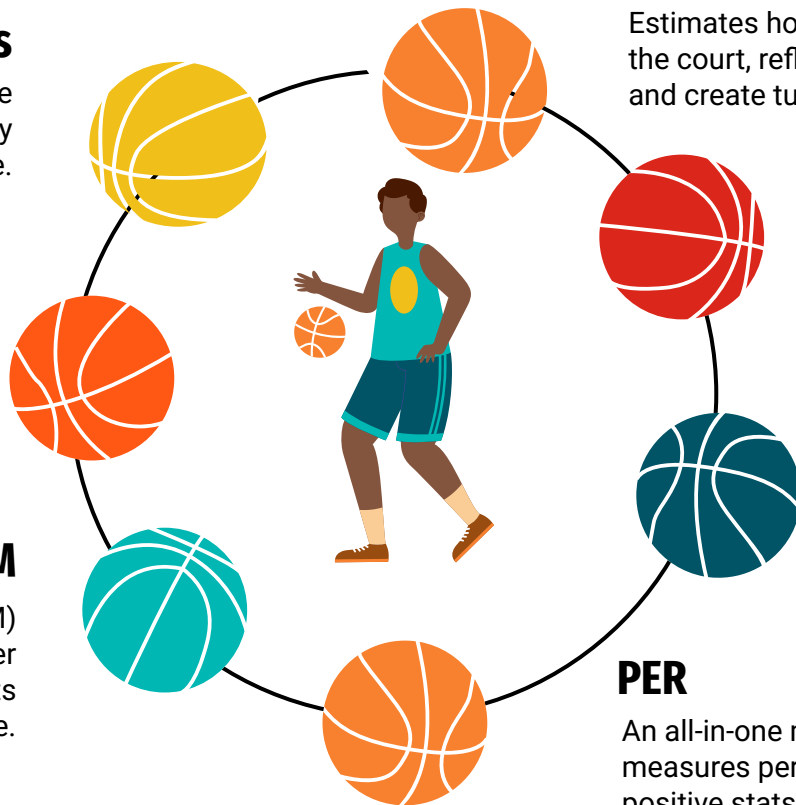
A person's value over their bench replacement

Block %

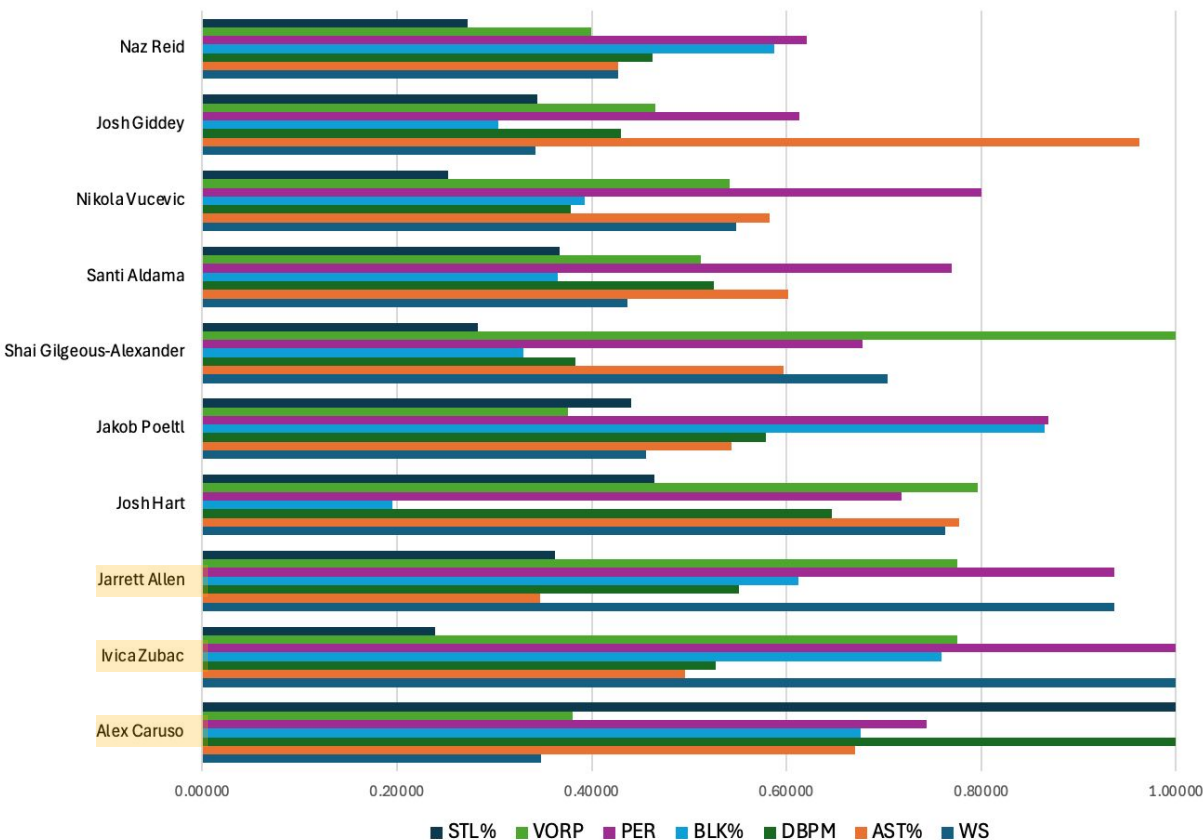
Measures how often a player blocks an opponent's shot while they're on the court.

PER

An all-in-one metric by John Hollinger that measures per-minute productivity by combining positive stats and subtracting negatives.



Highest Value Players



1



Alex Caruso

Elite defensive guard known for hustle, perimeter defense, and high-impact play despite modest scoring.

2



Ivica Zubac

Efficient, physical center who anchors the paint with strong rebounding, rim protection, and finishing.

3

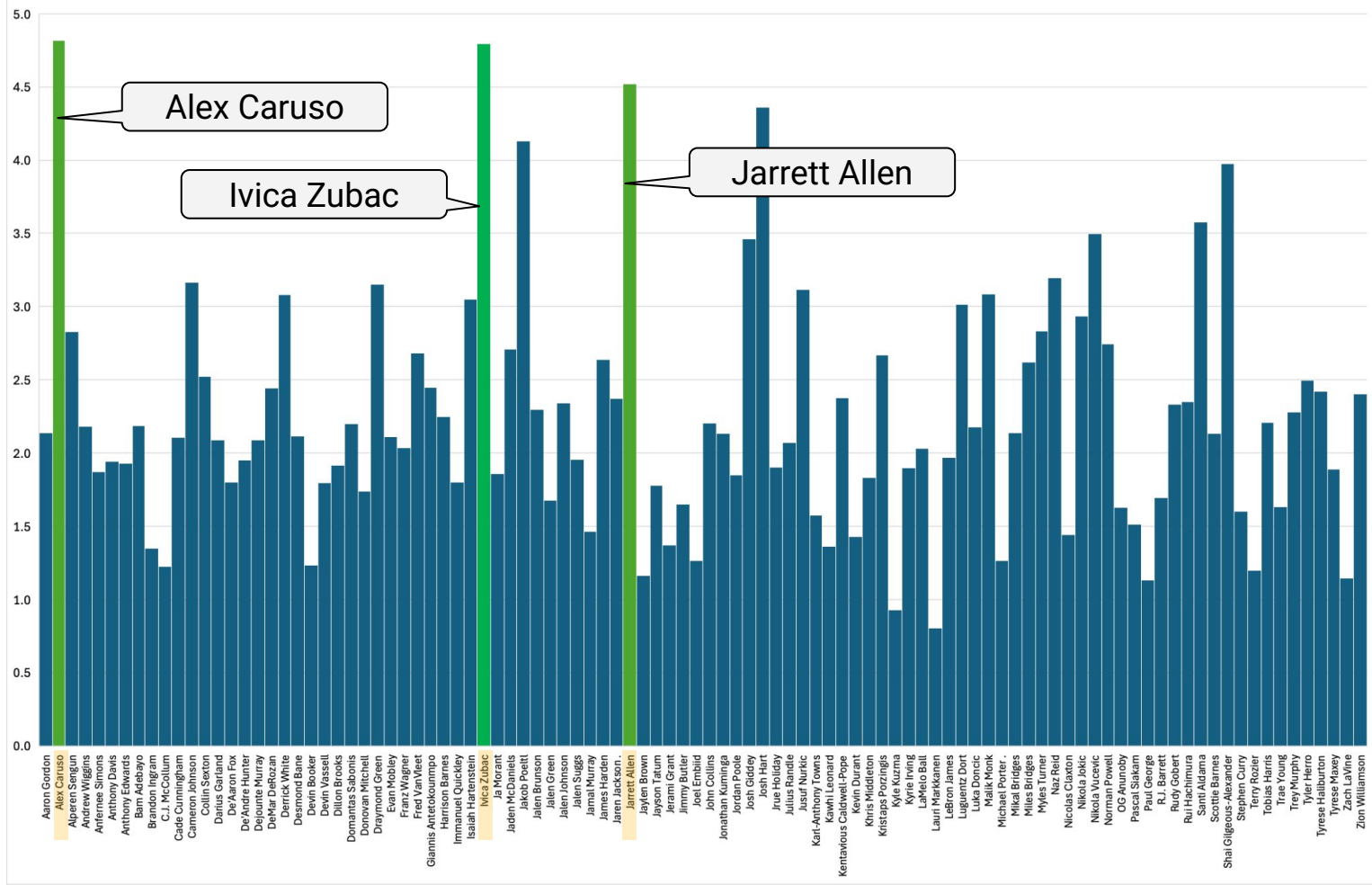


Jarrett Allen

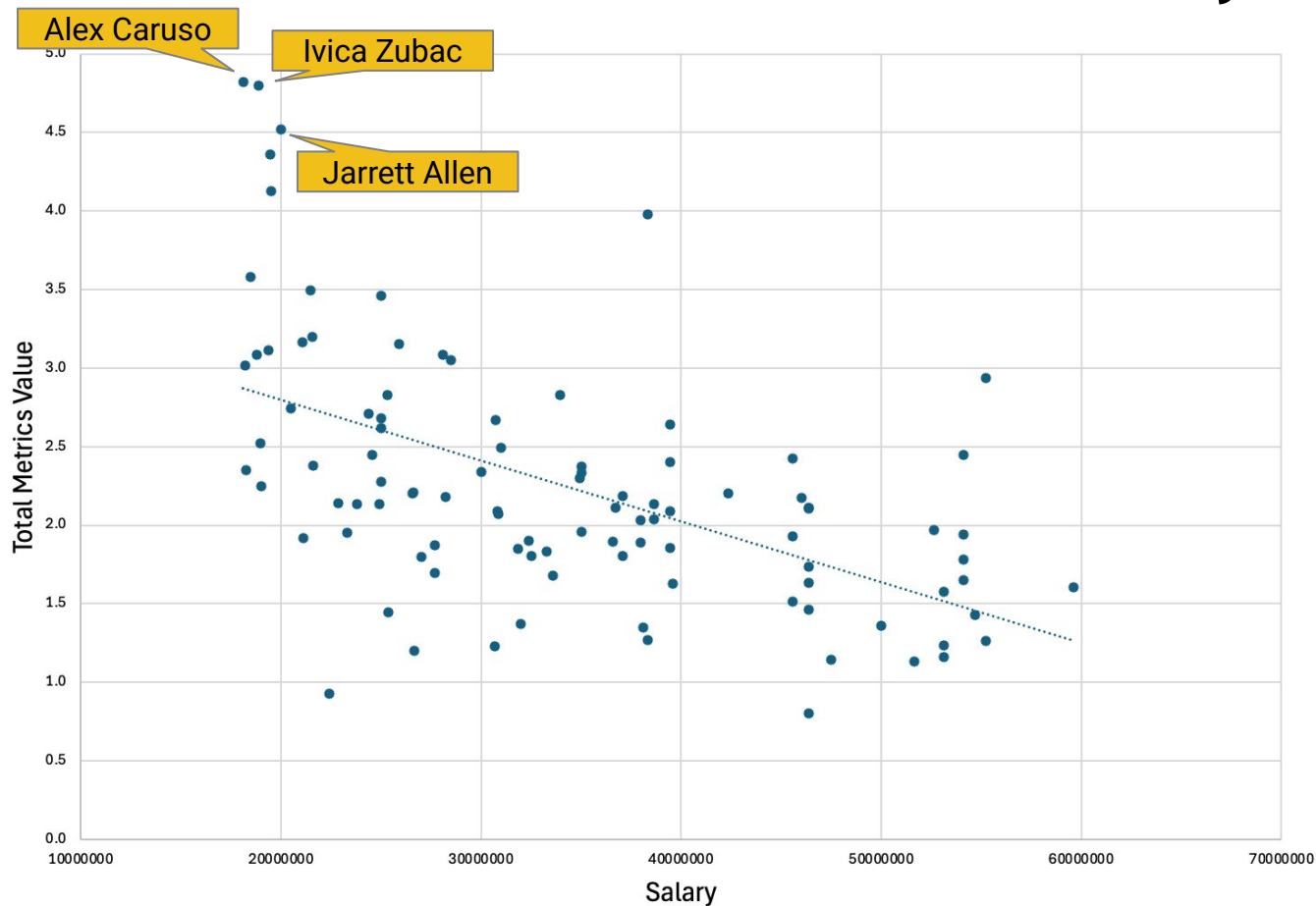
Athletic rim-protecting big man with elite shot-blocking, rebounding, and efficient inside scoring.

Players who deliver the most production relative to their salary, essentially the biggest “bang for your buck” based on performance versus cost.

Top 100 Players Value Score Ranking



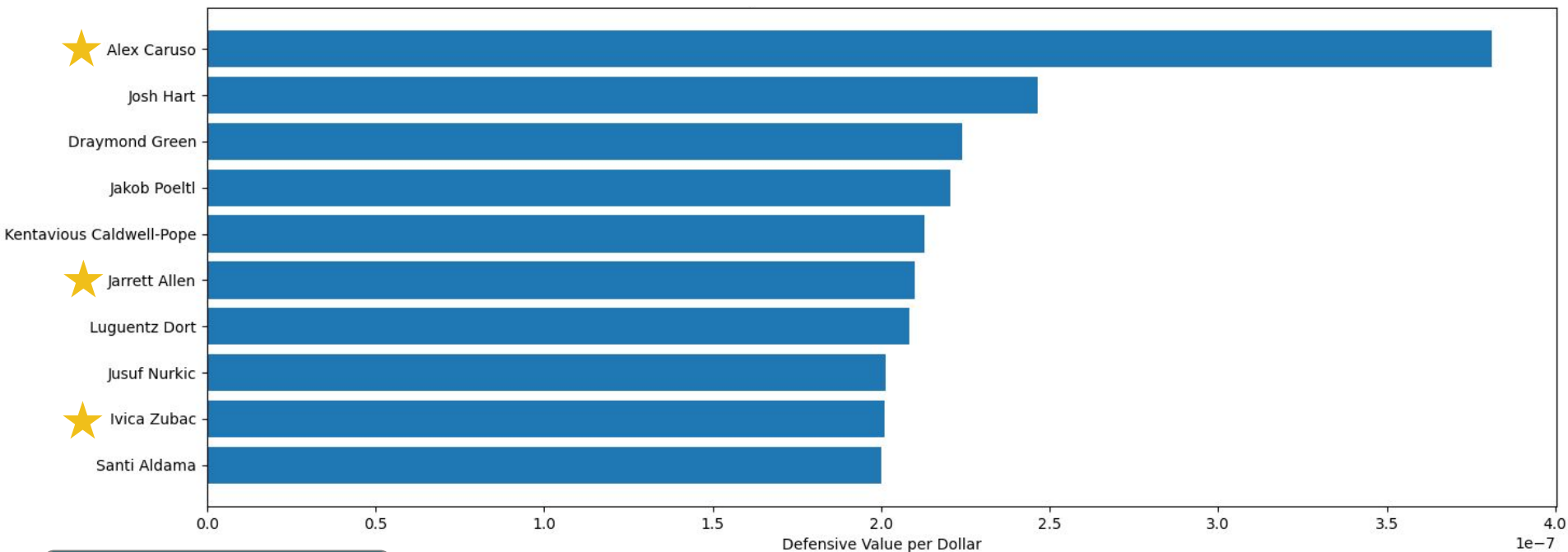
Total Metric Value vs Salary



Under the trendline =
overpaid

Over the trendline
= underpaid

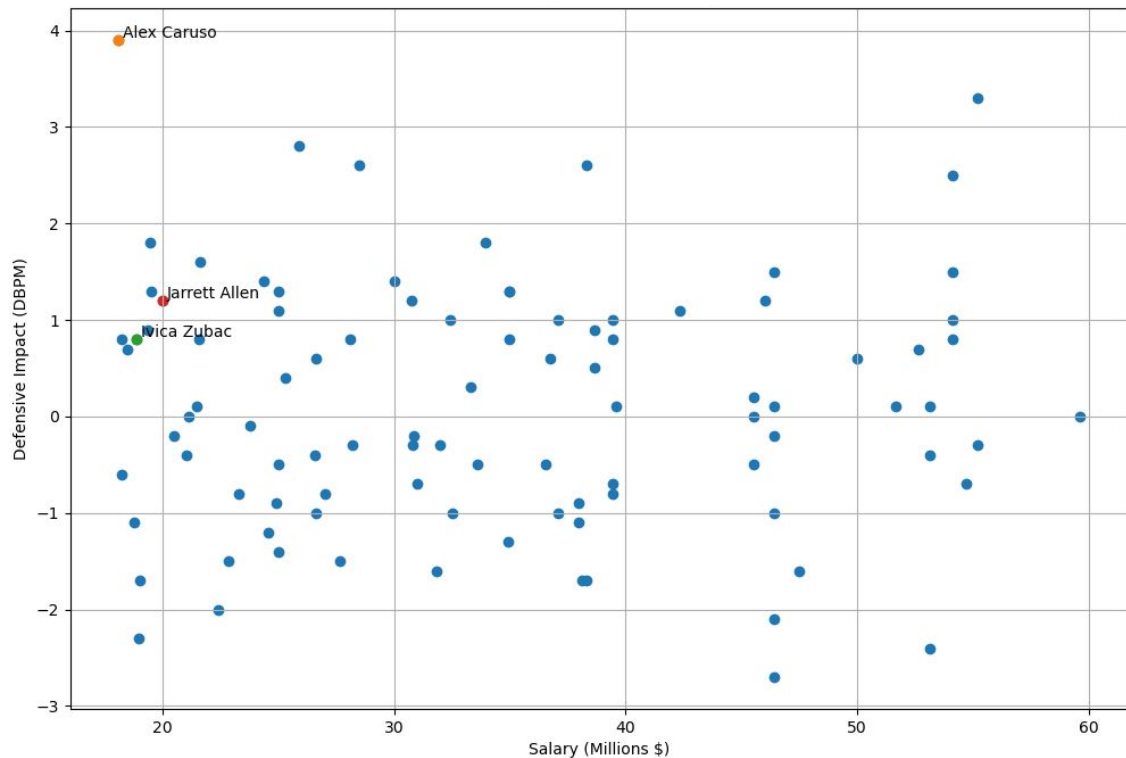
Top 10 Defensive Value Contracts



Defensive Takeaways:

- Caruso, Allen, and Zubac highlight how elite defensive impact—whether on the perimeter or in the paint—can be acquired at a fraction of superstar cost.
- Alex Caruso is the clear outlier in value
- Jarrett Allen and Ivica Zubac anchor elite value at center

NBA Salary vs Defensive Impact



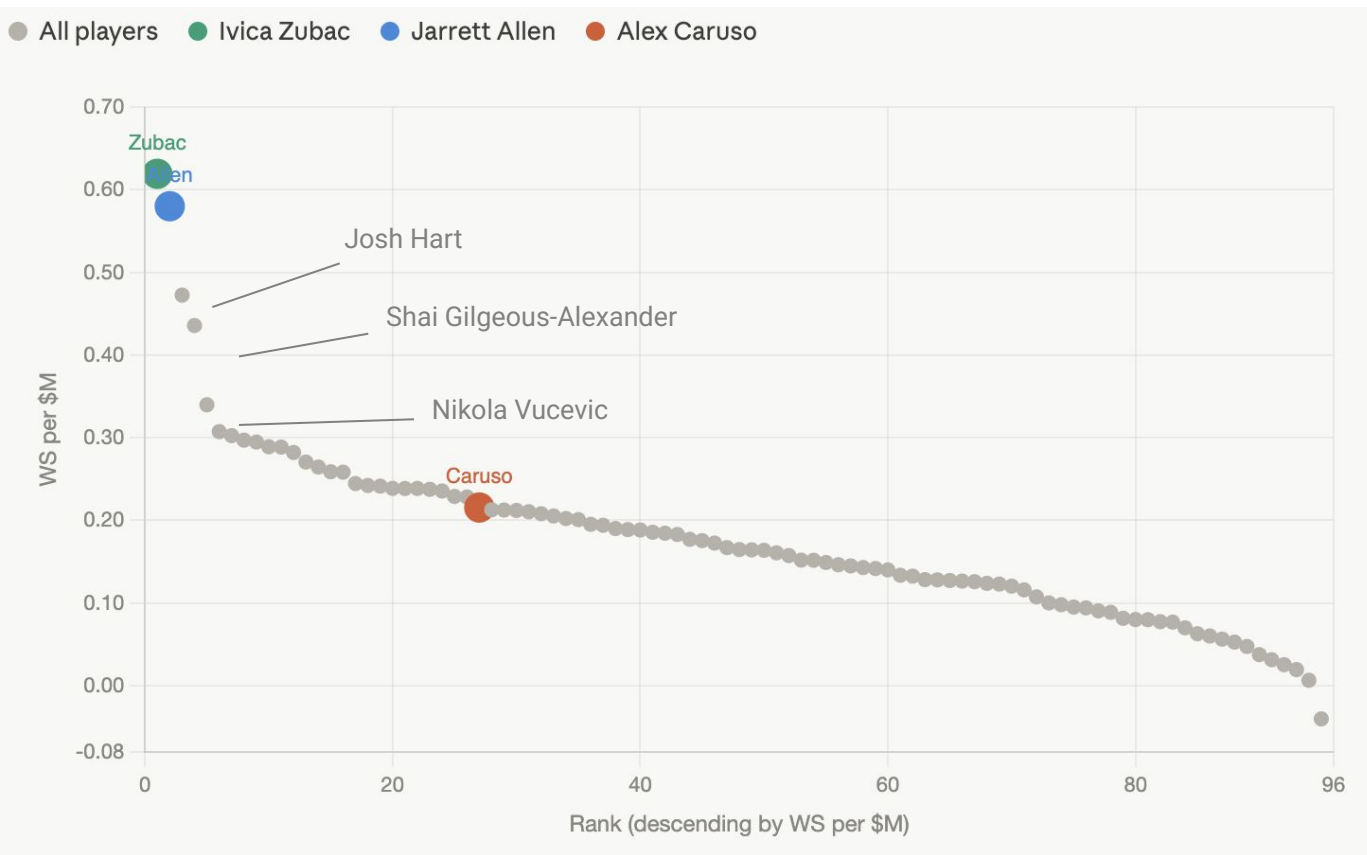
High salaries are often driven by offense and star power, not defense

Most players cluster around average defense regardless of pay

Alex Caruso stands out as a high-impact, low-cost outlier

Jarrett Allen and Ivica Zubac show strong defense at moderate salaries

Win Share Percentage per Million Dollars



Ivica Zubac

WS%:
0.61924

Std WS
%: 1

Rank 1

Jarrett Allen

WS%:
0.58

Std WS
%: 0.936

Rank 2

Alex Caruso

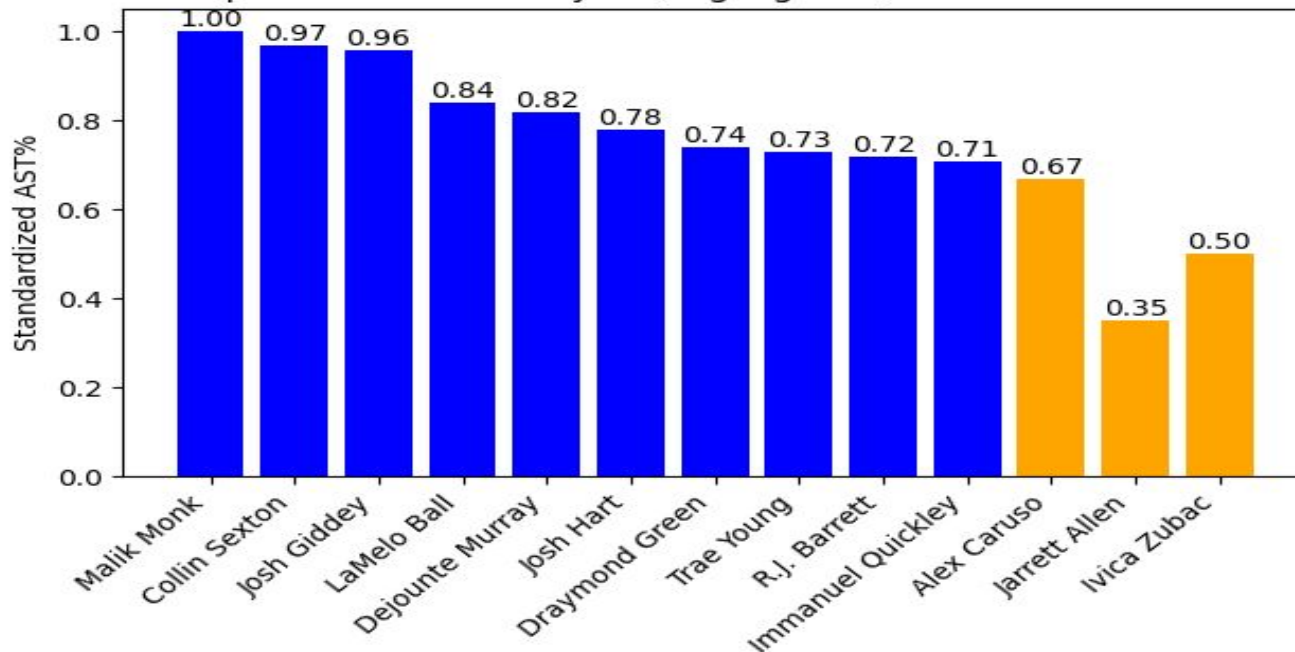
WS%:
0.21545

Std WS
%: 0.347

Rank 27

AST% of Highest Value Players

Top 10 + Selected Players (Highlighted) Standardized AST%



- Top 10 standardized AST% belong to guards, because AST%-value is heavily influenced by player position
- Caruso falls just outside the top 10 (15) as a guard
- Zubac (44) and Allen (71) are both centers, as they derive more of their value from other stats

Alex Caruso

AST%: 16.6

Standardized AST%: 0.67

Rank: 15/100

Ivica Zubac

AST%: 12.8

Standardized AST%: 0.5

Rank: 44/100

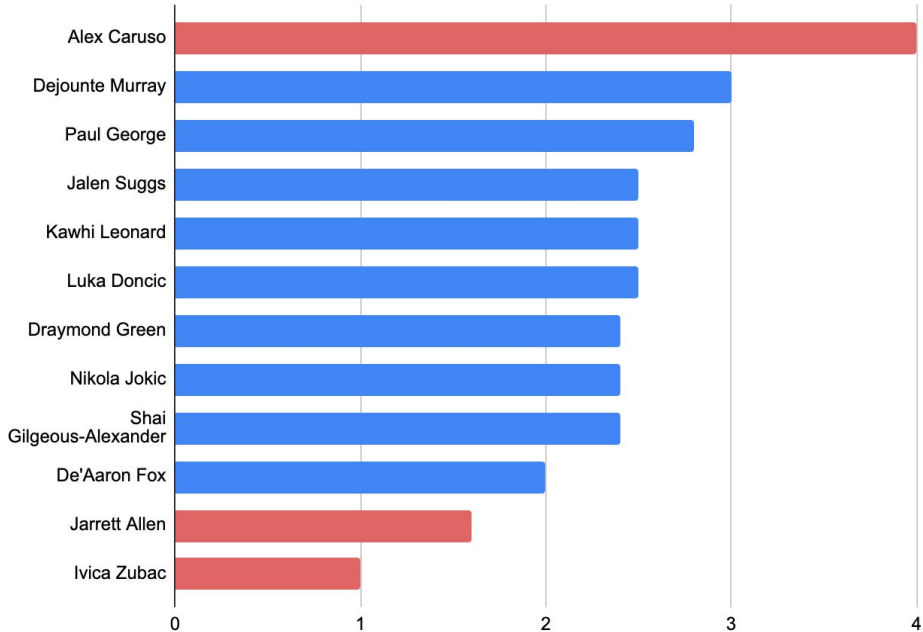
Jarrett Allen

AST%: 9.5

Standardized AST%: 0.35

Rank: 71/100

Steal Percentage (STL%)



Ivica Zubac
STL%: 1
Standardized STL%: 0.24
Rank: 95
Salary: 19M

Jarrett Allen
STL%: 1.6
Standardized STL%: 0.36
Rank: 89
Salary: 20M

Alex Caruso
STL%: 4
Standardized STL%: 1
Rank: 100
Salary: 18M

Caruso, is outperforming players making two times his salary.

PER of Highest Value Players

Alex Caruso

PER: 15.9

Standardized PER: 0.74

Rank: 72/100

Ivica Zubac

PER: 22.3

Standardized PER: 1

Rank: 12/100

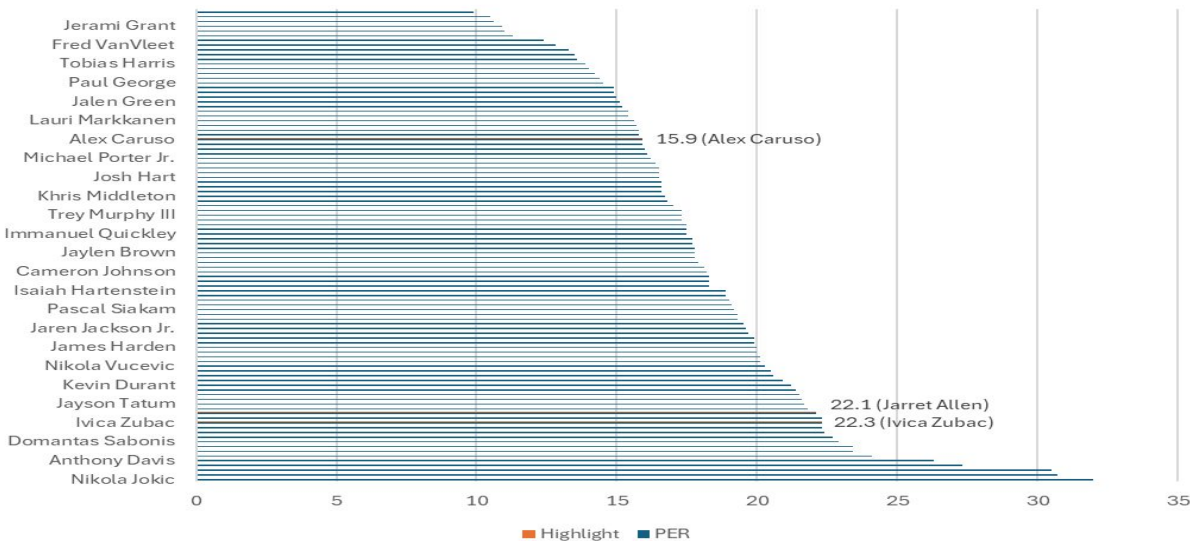
Jarrett Allen

PER: 22.1

Standardized PER: 0.93

Rank: 15/100

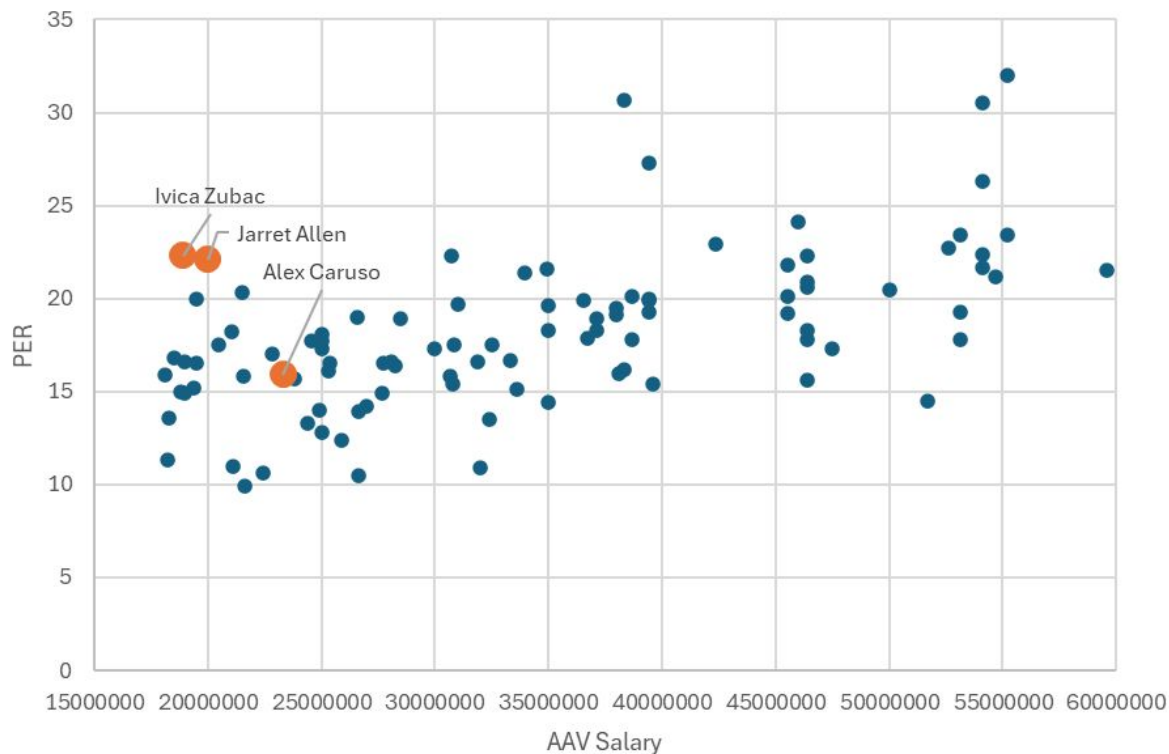
PER Rankings



- PER is an all-in-one basketball metric
- It sums up a player's positive accomplishments (points, rebounds, assists, blocks, steals)
- It also subtracts negative ones (missed shots, turnovers, fouls)
- This allows for Per minute efficiency comparisons (regardless of playing time)

PER vs. AAV Salary

PER vs. AAV Salary



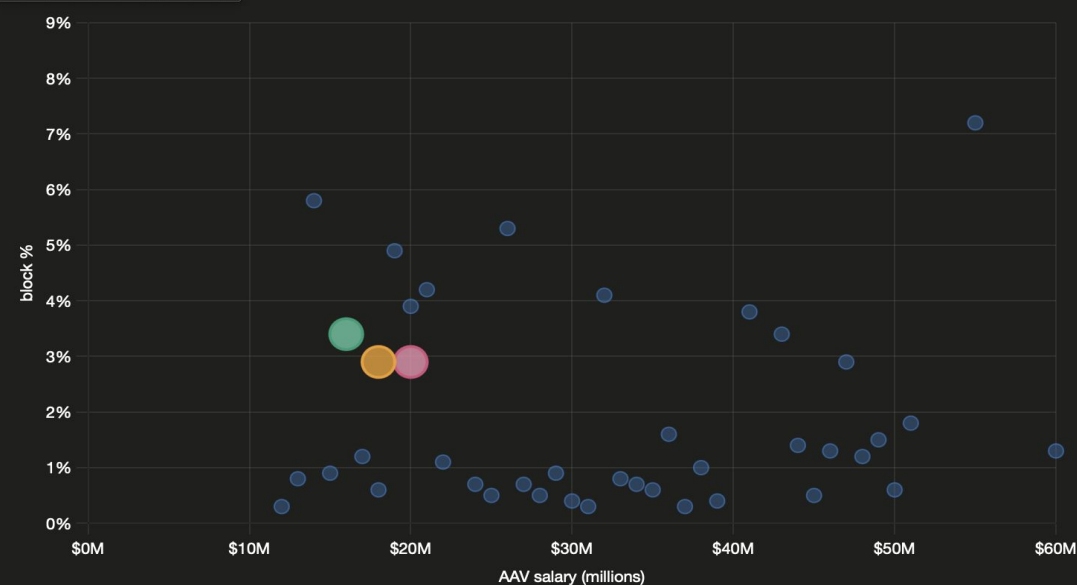
- Previous graphics show players such as Jokic, SGA, and Gannis are well worth their hefty price tags
- Jarrett Allen, Alex Caruso, and Ivica Zubac are all still considered some of the best bang for buck players as they provide relatively high PER values for low AAV Salaries

Block Percentage Visual - Salary vs. BLK%

Salary vs block % — top 100 players

Caruso, Zubac, and Allen deliver elite shot-blocking at a fraction of the max-contract price

Alex Caruso Ivica Zubac Jarrett Allen Other players



- shows that higher salary doesn't mean better shot-blocking
- most big contracts go to perimeter players who rarely block shots
- Caruso, Zubac, and Allen are the outliers
- all three sit in the lower salary range

Alex Caruso

BLK% was 2.9, played for OKC, and was ranked 100/120

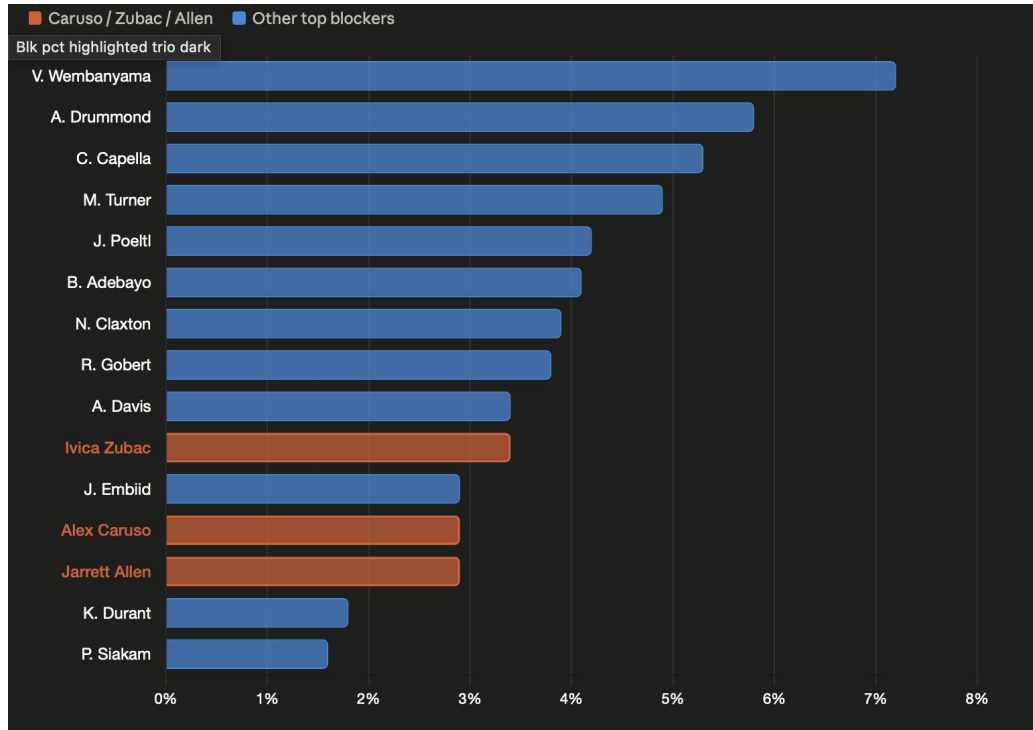
Ivica Zubac

BLK% was 3.4, played for LAC, and ranked 115/120

Jarrett Allen

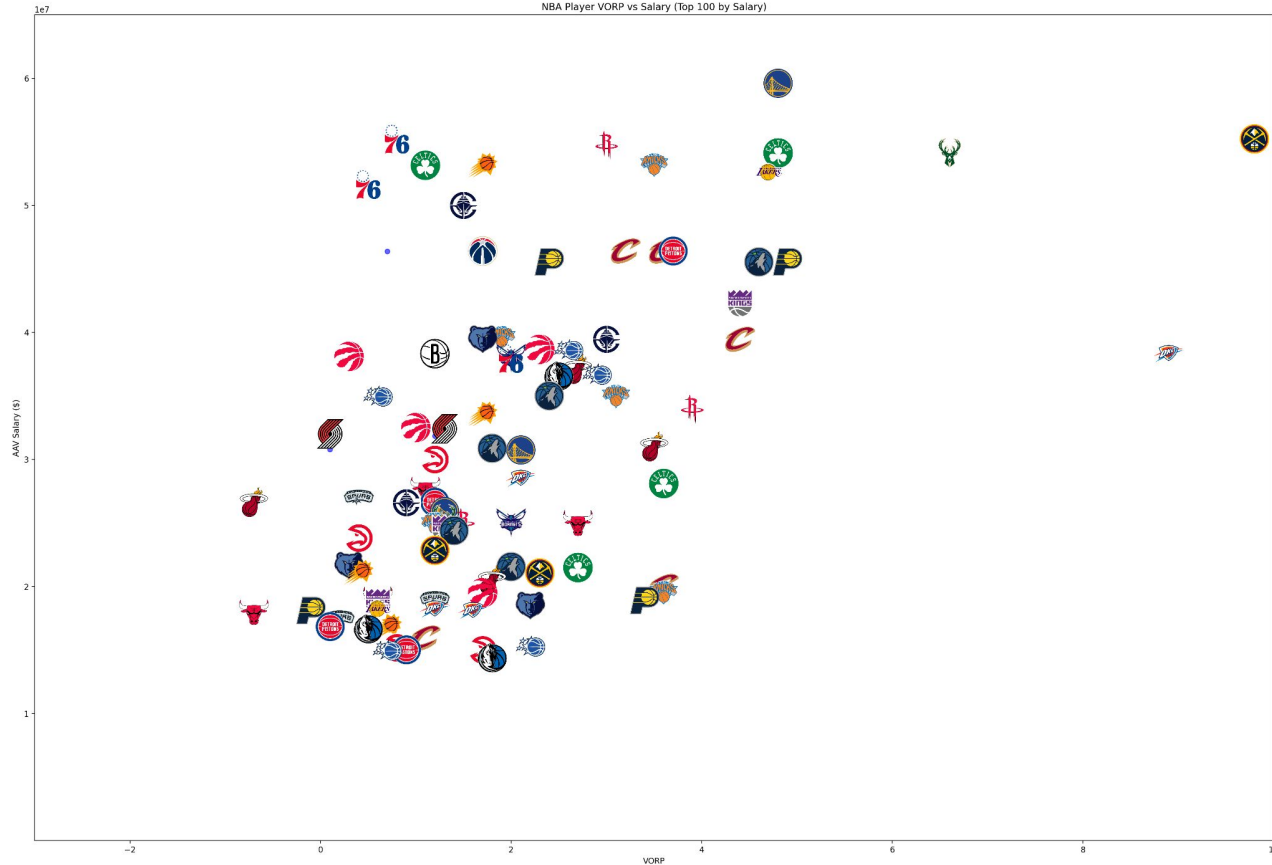
BLK% was 2.9, played for CLE, and was ranked 142

Block Percentage Visual - Top 15



- The top 15 shot-blockers among the 100 highest-paid NBA players, ranked by block percentage
- Zubac, Caruso, and Allen (coral bars) all sit at around 3%, ranking 10th through 13th in the group
- Caruso is the most surprising of the three since he is a guard, making a 2.9% block rate extremely rare for his position

Value Over Replacement Player (VORP)



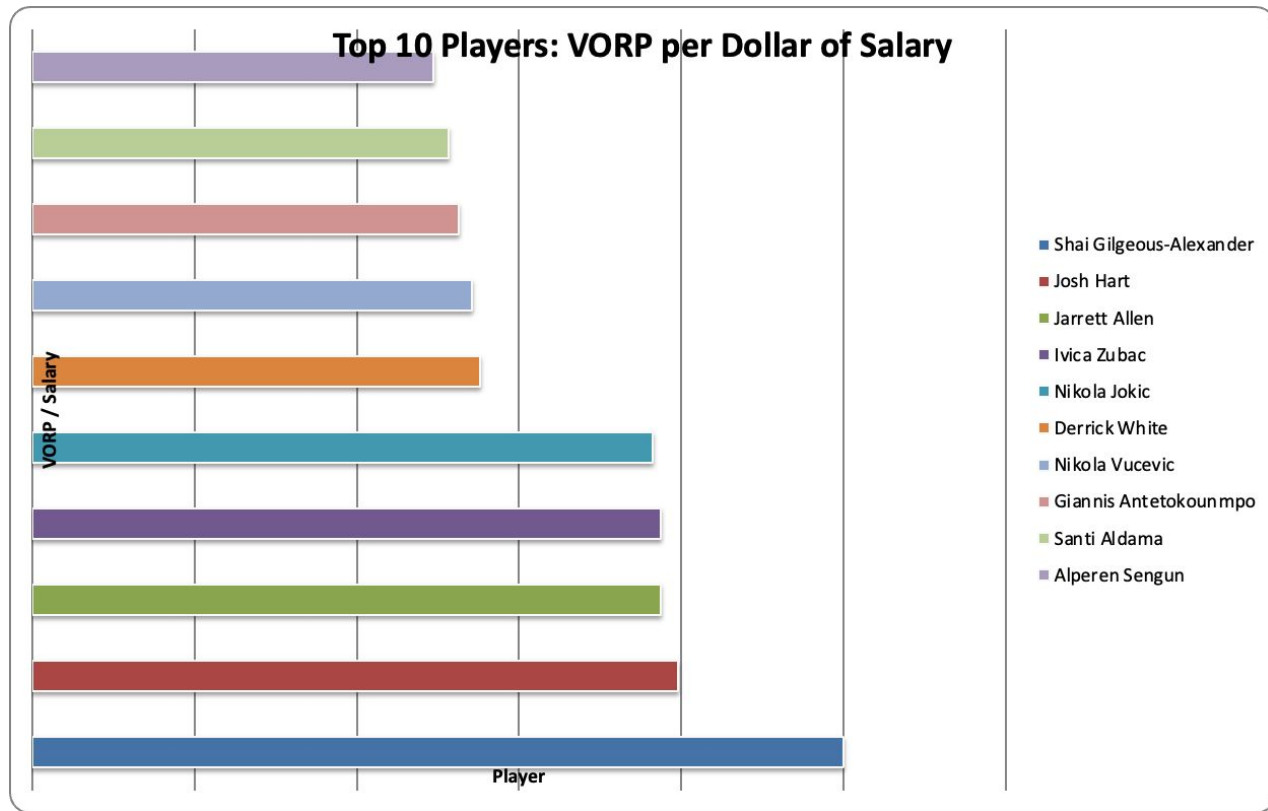
76ers give out bad contracts in relation to VORP

Shai is extremely underpaid

Clear top three in Jokic, SGA, and Giannis

Expensive contracts given to out of prime players

Standardized Vorp Per Dollar



Jokic and Giannis are worth their extensive contracts

Jarrett Allen and Ivica Zubac make are again notable when it comes to VORP

Most if not all players are in their prime athletic years



**THANK
YOU!**